MONTHLY UPDATE

Namibia: monthly update, September – October 2026

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> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · INCLUSION

Governance

Legislation and regulation · Data protection · Regional collaboration · Standards

Legislation and regulation

REGULATIONS ON ACCREDITATION OF SECURITY PRODUCTS, SERVICES AND PROVIDERS

- **Regulations regarding Accreditation of Security Products and Services and Providers of such Products and Services (Electronic Transactions Act 4 of 2019)** — Legal Assistance Centre (LAC) Namibia, reproducing General Notice 953 of 2025 (Communications Regulatory Authority of Namibia), 17 December 2025

  Namibia's Communications Regulatory Authority issued regulations under the Electronic Transactions Act 2019 setting out how security products, services and certification service providers are accredited, in General Notice 953 of 17 December 2025. They came into force on 15 June 2026; an accredited certification service provider may issue subscriber certificates and public keys for five years.

FINANCIAL INSTITUTIONS AND MARKETS ACT AND NAMFISA ACT

- **NAMFISA launches FinTech Square 2026 event to accelerate local innovation** — Namibia Economist, 18 September 2026

  The Namibia Financial Supervisory Authority announced its FinTech Square 2026 event for 14 October in Windhoek, with the Bank of Namibia and other partners. The event will launch the second cohort of NAMFISA's regulatory sandbox, covering crowdfunding and peer-to-peer lending, after a first cohort on microlending. Twelve exhibitors from the non-banking financial sector are to be selected.

- **Fintech will drive jobs, economic growth – Namfisa** — New Era, 21 September 2026

  The head of Namibia's financial regulator, Kenneth Matomola, said fintech could help with jobs and financial inclusion now that the Financial Institutions and Markets Act and a new Namfisa Act are in force. Both took effect on 1 May 2026. He cited youth unemployment of 44.4% in the 2023 labour force survey.

Data protection

UNITED STATES HEALTH DATA AND SPECIMEN SHARING PROPOSAL

- **US To Phase Out HIV Support For Namibia After Data-Sharing Impasse** — Health Policy Watch, 8 September 2026

> The United States will stop funding Namibia's HIV programme after 2027, providing $45m for fiscal 2027 for transition, after Namibia rejected US terms for sharing health data and pathogen information. Namibia has received about $1.1bn from PEPFAR over 22 years and already funds most treatment for around 220,000 people. It said the US terms conflict with constitutional privacy rights and its sovereignty over biological resources.

Regional collaboration

AFCFTA DIGITAL TRADE REGULATORY ASSESSMENT

- **Namibia reviews digital trade framework for AfCFTA protocol implementation** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026

  Namibia's assessment of its laws and institutions against the African free-trade area's Protocol on Digital Trade went to a validation workshop in Windhoek. It will feed a National Digital Trade Action Plan; no findings are published.

Standards

HARMONISED GOVERNMENT COMMUNICATION STRATEGY

- **Namibia's economic armoury: How new government communication strategy could unlock multibillion-dollar investment** — Business Express, 13 September 2026

  Namibia's ICT minister Emma Theofelus launched the Harmonised Government Communication Strategy 2026–2030 and the Government Corporate Brand Identity Manual at the public administration institute NIPAM on 9 September 2026. Cabinet approved both in March 2026; they set a single voice and brand for ministries, agencies, regional and local authorities and public enterprises.

Finance

New investments

New investments

UNIVERSAL SERVICE FUND ANNUAL ACCOUNTS

- **Namibia — Universal Service Fund Integrated Annual Report 2025** — Communications Regulatory Authority of Namibia (CRAN), for the Universal Service Fund, 1 September 2026

  The Communications Regulatory Authority of Namibia published the Universal Service Fund's 2025 integrated annual report, which carries the Fund's first financial statements, covering the 18 months to 31 December 2025. It also reports the Fund's Phase 1 (2024/25) and Phase 2 (2025/26) mobile radio access network deployments.

UNIVERSAL SERVICE FUND PHASE 2 AWARD TO THE MOBILE OPERATOR

- **Namibia accelerates network modernization to meet growing connectivity needs - Namibia Daily News** — Namibia Daily News (Xinhua), 28 September 2026

  Namibia's Mobile Telecommunications Company said on 28 September 2026 it has extended 5G to Grootfontein, Mariental, Okahandja, Otjiwarongo and Tsumeb and is building 19 new sites in nine regions. It was awarded N$32.3 million from phase 2 of the regulator CRAN's Universal Service Fund for 10 towers in underserved areas; ICT minister Emma Theofelus put 4G coverage at about 89%.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity · Data Storage · Cybersecurity

Connectivity

QUARTERLY CONNECTIVITY USAGE

- **Cyber threats rise 57% despite ICT sector growth** — New Era, 18 September 2026

  Namibia's communications regulator reports cyber threat events up 57 per cent and vulnerabilities up 40 per cent in the April-June quarter, alongside 2 per cent growth in mobile subscriptions to about 2.79 million and about N$243m invested in networks.

COMMERCIAL 5G NETWORK

- **Namibia accelerates network modernization to meet growing connectivity needs - Namibia Daily News** — Namibia Daily News (Xinhua), 28 September 2026

  Summarised under New investments.

LOW EARTH ORBIT SATELLITE BROADBAND SERVICE

- **Paratus Namibia launches Eutelsat's OneWeb LEO connectivity** — ITWeb Africa, 7 October 2026

  Paratus Namibia launched Eutelsat's OneWeb low-earth-orbit satellite internet service across Namibia on 7 October 2026, with capped and uncapped packages for homes and businesses. It follows a November 2025 agreement between Paratus and Eutelsat covering South Africa, Angola, Namibia, Botswana and Zambia. No prices are given.

Data Storage

NATIONAL AND PUBLIC DATA CENTRE

- **AI to boost digital services: Theofelus** — New Era, 25 September 2026

  Namibia's ICT minister, Emma Theofelus, said at the launch of the National AI Institute in Windhoek on 23 September 2026 that 4G covers about 89% of the country and internet use is about 62%. She said construction of the National Data Centre at Kenya House has begun. No measurement date for the coverage figures is given.

- **NCRST opens National AI Institute** — New Era, 25 September 2026

  Namibia's National Commission on Research, Science and Technology launched the National Artificial Intelligence Institute in Windhoek, with centres for research, software, datasets and AI innovation. The commission said 2,000 students have received AI training and it has funded two GPU-enabled high-performance computing centres at the Namibia University of Science and Technology and the University of Namibia. No cost is given.

Cybersecurity

REGULATOR AS ROOT CERTIFICATION AUTHORITY

- **Government told to stop making citizens carry ID copies** — observer24.com.na, 1 September 2026

  Namibia's National Root Certification Authority, operated by the communications regulator at the top of the country's digital trust chain, is technically live after a key-signing ceremony; the electronic signature provisions of the transactions act took effect on 15 June 2026.

- **Home Affairs becomes Namibia's first certification service provider** — New Era, 3 September 2026

  Namibia's communications regulator, CRAN, accredited the Ministry of Home Affairs, Immigration, Safety and Security as the country's first certification service provider under the Electronic Transactions Act of 2019, announced in Windhoek in the week of 3 September 2026. The four-year accreditation lets the ministry issue digital certificates and encryption keys for government services, following a key signing ceremony on 28 August.

GLOBAL CYBERSECURITY INITIATIVE

- **Global Cybersecurity Initiative: Unifying Africa via Cybersecurity** — The Villager Newspaper, 4 September 2026

  DS Tech Namibia launched the Global Cybersecurity Initiative, a private pan-African platform to connect businesses, governments and innovators on cybersecurity, in Windhoek on 3 September 2026. Chaired by Paulinus Sheehama, it starts in Namibia, Kenya, Botswana, Ghana, Nigeria, Zambia and South Africa and aims to cover 52 African countries by 2029.

RANSOMWARE ATTACK ON THE NAMIBIAN DEFENCE FORCE

- **Hackers hit NDF: RansomHouse threatens state secrets** — The Namibian, 20 September 2026

  A ransomware group listed the Namibian Defence Force among its victims and published an evidence pack it says shows access to the force's systems, with a message accusing its IT department of concealing the incident. No confirmation or response from the force is on record, and the defence minister said he had not heard of it.

- **Namibia's Defence Ministry hit by double-extortion ransomware attack** — Tech News Namibia, 20 September 2026

  Namibia's national cyber incident response team, NAM-CSIRT, confirmed unauthorised activity on the Ministry of Defence and Veterans Affairs network and attributed it to the RansomHouse ransomware group, reported on 20 September 2026. It is coordinating investigation and recovery. It did not say what data was accessed, stolen or encrypted.

NATIONAL COMPUTER SECURITY INCIDENT RESPONSE TEAM

- **CRAN appoints Cornelia Shipindo to lead Namibia's cyber incident response** — TechNews Namibia, 3 October 2026

  Cornelia Shipindo became Executive of the Namibia Cyber Security Incident Response Team on 1 October 2026, the Communications Regulatory Authority of Namibia, which houses the team, announced. She will lead national incident response, threat preparedness and protection of critical information infrastructure.

NATIONAL PUBLIC KEY INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Namibia strengthens digital trust** — Market Watch (Namibia Media Holdings), 4 October 2026

  Namibia's communications regulator launched DigiNam in Windhoek on 31 August as the public face of the national public key infrastructure, for which the regulator is root certification authority. It is meant to support electronic signatures, digital identity and authenticated online transactions under the Electronic Transactions Act of 2019.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

Digital Identity and CRVS

NATIONAL ELECTRONIC IDENTITY CARD

- **Government briefs lawmakers on new digital e-ID card** — Namibia Economist, 6 October 2026

Namibia's home affairs and ICT ministries briefed members of parliament on the rollout of a new electronic identity card. MPs asked about system security, cyberattacks, backups and who owns and controls the technology where private providers are involved, and about a proposed Resident Identity Card for long-term foreign residents. The briefing date is not given.

- **Namibia MPs press government on security, access and reach of planned digital ID | Biometric Update** — Biometric Update, 8 October 2026

  Namibian MPs questioned the planned digital ID on rural reach, cost, data ownership and cybersecurity at a briefing by two ministries. The rollout planned for September was delayed because the legal framework had not been finalised.

Digital Payments and Fintech

INSTANT PAYMENT SOLUTION

- **Explainer: What is WayaMe?** — The Namibian, 3 September 2026

  WayaMe is the public name for Namibia's new instant payment system, operated by Instant Payments Namibia under the Bank of Namibia. It routes payments between participating banks and e-money wallets, which customers reach through their existing apps or USSD. The system is expected over time to carry government grants and pensions. No launch date is given.

SOCIAL GRANT BENEFICIARIES LOCKED OUT OF THE PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **NamPost grant system faces scrutiny, elderly left stranded** — The Namibian, 7 September 2026

  Retired Namibian MP Elifas Dingara called on the government and Namibia Post Limited, which pays social cash grants, to address failures in the grant payment system. He said elderly beneficiaries had travelled long distances and queued only to find their names missing at payment points. He asked for answers on missing beneficiaries, delayed and unpaid grants, and complaint timeframes.

- **5 700 grant beneficiaries still locked out of payment system** — Namibian Sun, 10 September 2026

  More than 5,700 Namibian pensioners and other social-grant beneficiaries remain locked out of the government payment system after their grants were suspended during an identity verification exercise earlier in 2026, the gender equality and child welfare minister told the National Assembly. She said 15,785 were affected in all, of whom 10,066 had verified their identities, been reinstated and paid, and defended the exercise as ensuring public money reaches only legitimate beneficiaries while acknowledging it had delayed vulnerable people.

Registries

MARRIAGE RECORDS DIGITALISATION

- **Home affairs minister Iipumbu urges married couples to ensure they are registered** — The Namibian, 10 October 2026

  Namibia's home affairs minister, Lucia Iipumbu, told the National Assembly that some marriages remain unregistered because registers held by churches and magistrates' courts reach the ministry late or never. The gap came to light during records digitisation begun in 2021; the system relies on paper submission and does not track delivery, and some historical records are still in South Africa. Couples are urged to check their registration.

CHILD-GRANT PAYMENTS TO INELIGIBLE AND DECEASED RECIPIENTS

- **Audit finds N$28.8m in duplicate child grant payments** — The Namibian, 13 October 2026

> Namibia's Auditor-General found that the ministry responsible for child grants kept paying 32,890 beneficiaries aged 19 to 21, at N$250m a year, in 2024/25, reported on 13 October 2026. The audit also found 3,350 duplicate child records, with N$28.8m paid twice, and more than N$43m paid to deceased recipients, nearly 4,000 of them over two months after their deaths were registered.

Sectoral management information systems

> NATIONAL LABOUR MARKET INFORMATION SYSTEM (NALMIS)

- **NSA launches first labour market information system** — NAMPA, 25 September 2026

  The Namibia Statistics Agency and the Ministry of Justice and Labour Relations launched the country's first National Labour Market Information System on 24 September 2026, to bring labour data from government institutions and the private sector onto one platform.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

> DIGITAL DISABILITY ASSESSMENT SYSTEM

- **Digital disability system faces rural roadblocks** — The Namibian, 8 September 2026

  Namibia's health ministry has launched a digital disability assessment system. On 8 September 2026 the Namibian Organisation of Youth with Disabilities welcomed the change but warned that poor rural connectivity, inadequate equipment and limited digital skills could make the system a new barrier outside the main towns.

> GOVERNMENT PENSION FUND INTEGRATED ADMINISTRATION SYSTEM

- **GIPF to invest N$40m in new pension administration system** — The Brief (Namibia), 23 September 2026

  Namibia's Government Institutions Pension Fund plans to spend about N$40m on a new pension administration system built by Kenyan firm Cystech, its chief operating officer, Elvis Nashilongo, said, reported on 23 September 2026. Less than N$5m has been spent and the build should take about 16 months. The fund has signed data-sharing agreements with the revenue agency, the finance and home affairs ministries and financial institutions.

> STANDARDISED REPORTING TEMPLATE FOR ONLINE GOVERNMENT SERVICES

- **Cabinet directs MICT to standardise online service reporting** — NAMPA, 8 October 2026

  Namibia's Cabinet directed the ICT ministry to develop a standard template for reporting which government services are available online.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Digitalisation of sub-national government

> INNOVATE4WATER SMART WATER-METERING PILOT

- **Namibia project uses household data, smart meters to rethink water** — Science Granting Councils Initiative Africa, 21 September 2026

  Innovate4Water, a research project led by the Namibia University of Science and Technology, surveyed 692 households in Windhoek, Rundu and Ongwediva and found only 25% reported uninterrupted water supply. In Ongwediva the team fitted 69 pulse readers to household meters to produce time-stamped consumption data, with AI to flag possible leaks and unauthorised use. No verified reduction in water losses is reported.

Technology

AI · Innovation ecosystem

AI

AI AND SATELLITE CROP-MONITORING CONTRACT

- **US firm 6th Grain demands N$13m for cancelled crop tender** — The Namibian, 14 September 2026

  US firm 6th Grain Corporation is demanding N$13 million from Namibia's government after Cabinet ordered its crop-monitoring contract cancelled for failing legal and procedural requirements. A demand letter dated 9 September 2026 claims payment for completed work, commercial loss and reputational damage.

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE INSTITUTE

- **Namibia to launch AI institute to strengthen national capacity** — Namibia Business Review, 22 September 2026

  Namibia's National Commission on Research, Science and Technology said on 22 September 2026 that it would launch the National Artificial Intelligence Institute of Namibia the next day. The institute will run four centres, including one to curate Namibian datasets, and its youth AI fellowship is training about 2,000 tertiary students. No budget is given.

- **AI to boost digital services: Theofelus** — New Era, 25 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Storage.

- **NCRST opens National AI Institute** — New Era, 25 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Storage.

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE INSTITUTE

- **National AI Institute launched** — The Namibian, 27 September 2026

  Namibia's ICT minister launched a National Artificial Intelligence Institute in Windhoek, made up of software development, datasets, innovation and research centres. It is to work on skills, local datasets and uses in health, education, food security, energy and public services.

INTERNAL POLICY ON CIVIL SERVANTS' USE OF AI

- **Government directs AI policy for civil servants as ICT Summit opens in Ongwediva** — Namibia Economist, 13 October 2026

  Namibia's Cabinet has directed the Office of the Prime Minister and the ICT ministry to develop an internal policy on civil servants' use of artificial intelligence, the ICT minister announced at the National ICT Summit. No timeline or draft was given.

Innovation ecosystem

NON-BANK FINANCIAL REGULATOR'S REGULATORY SANDBOX

- **NAMFISA launches FinTech Square 2026 event to accelerate local innovation** — Namibia Economist, 18 September 2026

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Inclusion

Access to services

Access to services

DIGITISATION OF DISABILITY ASSESSMENT AND GRANT ACCESS

- **Grant system goes digital to better serve disabled Namibians** — Namibian Sun, 8 September 2026

  Namibia is putting new guidelines and digital systems behind the medical assessment of persons with disabilities and their access to social grants.

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